SHIPS

Tracker Plus · frequently asked questions · live tankers and cargo ships on a sea chart

Setup

What do I need?
Your own free aisstream.io key (the ship data service) and a phone on the same Wi-Fi as your Tracker Plus. It takes about a minute, once.

How do I enter the key?
Tap Ships on the Home screen. It shows a QR code. Scan it with your phone camera (or type the address shown into the phone's browser) and follow the steps there: sign in to aisstream.io (Google or GitHub), go to API Keys, tap Create, copy the key, paste it and tap Save. The key is saved on your Tracker Plus only. Or tap Type it to enter the key on the screen.

Can I see it without a key?
Yes: tap Demo on the key screen for sample ships in the Strait of Hormuz. SET > AIS key ends the demo.

How do I change the key?
SET > AIS key.

How do I get back to the Home screen?
Tap SET, then Home.

Using it

How do I pick a location?
SET > Find place: type a port or city (e.g. Rotterdam), or coordinates like 51.05,1.45. Or SET > Hot spots for busy places in one tap, including the Strait of Hormuz.

How do I move and zoom the map?
Swipe on the map to pan. Use the - and + buttons in the top bar to zoom. Each change reloads the map, which takes about 5-15 seconds.

How do I see a ship's details?
Tap a ship. The bottom bar shows its name, speed, heading, destination and length. Tap the bottom bar to step through ships one by one.

What else is in the SET menu?
Settings (Wi-Fi, touch calibration, sound and the rest, in Home > Settings) and Done (back to the map).

What the screen shows

Red ship shape	Tanker (HAZ A-D = hazardous cargo category)
Green ship shape	Cargo ship
Grey dot	Ship heard, type not received yet
Solid circle	Tanker/cargo stopped, anchored or moored
White line	Where the ship will be in 10 minutes
White dots	Wake trail - where it has been
Yellow ring	Selected ship
Dot in top bar	Green = live, orange = connecting, red = problem

Why is the land brown and the sea blue?
Map tiles (Esri) are recoloured into a chart: sandy coastline, brown land, blue sea getting deeper offshore. The scale bar is in nautical miles.

Troubleshooting

Why does it take a while after opening or moving the map? Please be patient.
Each time it opens, or you move or zoom the map, it downloads fresh map tiles and ship data. Allow a few seconds up to a minute before everything shows.

Why are the ships grey dots at first?
A ship sends its position every few seconds, but its type only about every 6 minutes. Until the type arrives it is a grey dot. Give a new area 5-10 minutes.

Why are some grey dots disappearing?
Once their type arrives they turn out to be tugs, ferries, fishing or pleasure boats, which are hidden. Only tankers and cargo ships stay.

It says 0 tankers, 0 cargo - is it broken?
The area may just be quiet. Zoom out, or try Hot spots > Rotterdam or Dover Strait.

Why are there so few ships at Hormuz?
aisstream uses volunteer shore receivers. Coverage there is thin, so many ships are not received.

Does it remember ships?
Yes. Known ship types are saved, so they show in colour straight away next time.

The status dot is red.
The key is missing or rejected (the bottom bar says so - SET > AIS key), or Wi-Fi dropped.

The map is blank or says tile errors.
The map server could not be reached. Check Wi-Fi, then zoom or pan to reload.

Why does opening SET pause the ships?
The live feed pauses while you are in the menus to free memory, and resumes when you tap Done.

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